Water Memory
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Inspiration

Water memory theory - claimed ability of water to retain a "memory" of substances previously dissolved in it to arbitrary dilution. Believe that **water molecules are affected by human thoughts -** the negative or positive words, emotions, and music can influence water's form, producing either beautiful order structure (crystals) or ugly chaos shapes when freezing. Basically we can say that according to the theory there is a good or bad water depending of it structure and it influence on human body is radically different.

Idea

- The project is based on augmented reality system allowing to layer multimedia content on the live image from the camera mobile device.
- It creates a virtual (augmented reality) space located in a certain location of citi. *(see page 6, 7, 8)*
  - **The space -** reservoir fill with water.
- The viewer entering the location with tablet or smartphone in his hands is virtually diving underwater. By walking and changing the position of the device he/she is exploring **the underwater world** full of floating memories and stories.
  - **The underwater world -** is fill with photos, postcards, letters, everyday things floating in a water. All those items are building a narrative descriptions of important formative memories from local history experience, from the collective memory of region. I am not going to attempt to explain the meaning of the events. Instead to paint a mental image of the memory of the place. All those spots of memory are creating a **nonlinear story** of the project.

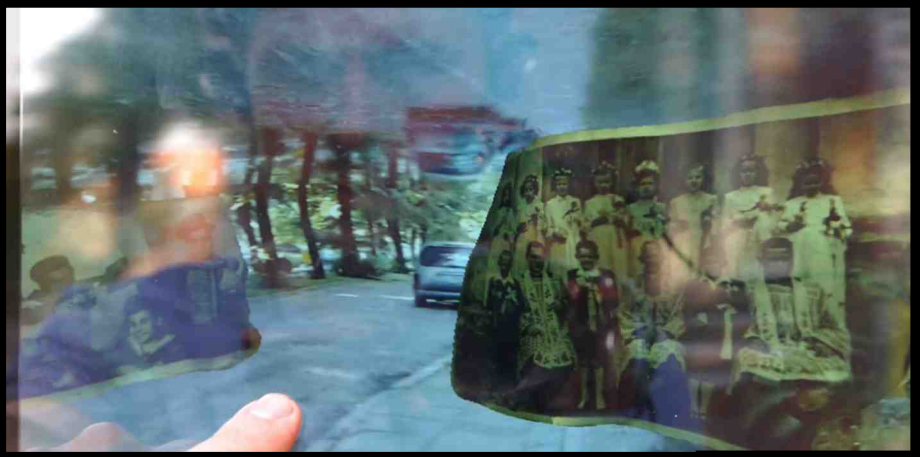
User impression

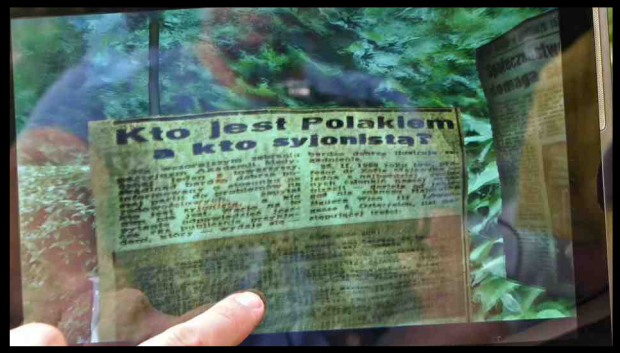
By entering the **“the space”** the one is finding himself in outer space (underwater world). Aiming the camera of the device he sees the real environment (buildings, cars, tress, people passing by etc.) but with impression that the certain part of the city is floated by water (see page 10, 11). The water reservoir has clearly visible limits (like brick of ice) according to the occupied part of the town. During the exploration of **“the space**” (by walking around) the user is finding on his way different items possibly coming from the “floated” apartments but this is not so important to understand from where the items are coming. It is possible to drag closer each floating item and to have a closer look of it. The special individual audio samples (like voice telling a story or singing or part of the conversation and so on) are activated when one is in direct close contact with item. The audio is playing very important role in the project. The users should experience the project only with headphones on. The soundtrack is fill with underwater sounds: waives, air bubbles, unidentified sounds of living creatures, echoes etc. The impression of the world in the project is not far from visual delusions - *one have to be very careful moving in the public space of the city.* All of the **items** are placed in a fixed position on the space grid the user have to explore the underwater world very precisely to be able to collect all of the separate samples and to build his own story out of it. By exploring your physical environment each several meters your are going to make a jump in time. Watch out the waves!

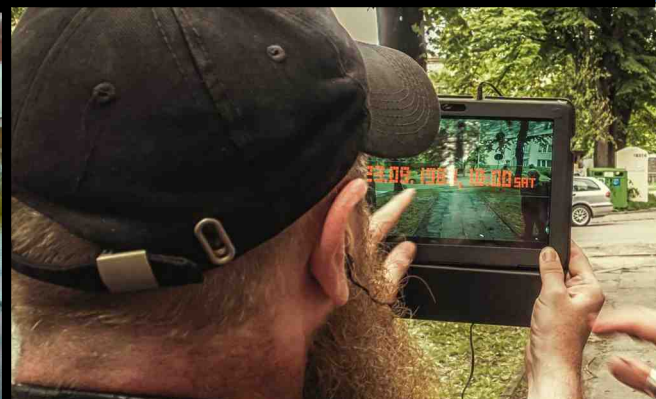
Story

Water is the birthplace. The “metaplace” - the begging of exploration of the unknown, a place where life started. It is also often the end, death point - diving back into the unknown. Ocean is a metaphor for the history, struggles and human efforts his victories and defeats, elation and falls in the vastness of the universe. The sea is also a space of battle, utopia and disaster, the field of relationship of the individual and the community, in the personal sense the place of work and entertainment and related dreams, ambition, loneliness and madness.

It is important for me to create a "story" filled with emotional personal memories of individuals. Story that has universal significance and values that are not assigned to one specific event or place but can be read and understood globally. An important element is the fact that this is hypertext story where meanings and time sounds individually depending on the user choices. Short pieces of information that one is going to faced are the symbols, full of emotional tension with multiple interpretations and an impulse to stimulate audience emotions.







Water Memory, Gdańsk, 06.2013

Localization in Gdansk